



OPTION A
Vienna

A THREE-DAY ESCAPE FROM INTERLAKEN, BY TRAIN

Vienna *or* Munich?

Tuesday 8 – Thursday 10 September 2026 · one traveller

Timetables, hotel rates and forecasts checked 5 September 2026 · Munich fare anchored on your SBB quote (CHF 107)



OPTION B
Munich

Munich for *this* window. Vienna when you can give it four days.

Both cities are wonderful in early September. The difference is arithmetic: Munich is six hours from Interlaken West with one change; Vienna is eleven. On a Tuesday-to-Thursday trip that is the difference between two full days on the ground and one.

- 1

Time. Munich: arrive 11:16 Tuesday, leave 12:32 or 14:32 Thursday. Vienna: arrive 17:32 at the earliest, leave 10:28 Thursday.
- 2

Money. Munich's fare is verified at CHF 107 one-way. Vienna will run roughly CHF 130–185 each way. Hotels cost about the same in both at every tier.
- 3

Weather. Wednesday is wet everywhere (Munich gets thunderstorms, Vienna showers). Either city needs one museum day, and both have great ones.

If the Staatsoper is the point, Vienna still wins: *Adriana Lecouvreur* on Tuesday night is reachable on the 06:34 train. See page 4.

	Vienna	Munich
DOOR TO DOOR	10 h 58 · 2 changes or 11 h 28 with 1 change	6 h 12 · 1 change 5 h 42 with 3 changes
TRAIN FARE, ONE-WAY	≈ CHF 130–185 estimate Swiss leg + ÖBB Sparschiene / Standard	CHF 107 SBB, verified 05:30 departure, 2nd class
TIME ON THE GROUND	Tue evening · Wed · Thu morning ≈ 1 full day + 2 half days	Tue afternoon · Wed · Thu morning ≈ 2 full days
HOTELS, PER NIGHT	€92 – €646 checked sweet spot €210 (Grand Ferdinand, 25hours)	€89 – €400 checked sweet spot €144 – €210 (Ruby Lilly, Platzl)
FORECAST 8 → 10 SEPT	32° sun → showers → 20° cloud Wed ≈ 9 mm	30° warm → thunderstorms → 17° Wed ≈ 27 mm
ON THESE DATES	Staatsoper: <i>Adriana Lecouvreur</i> Tue, <i>Figaro</i> Wed Kino am Dach open-air cinema to 11 Sept	The Black Keys at Zenith, Wed Wiesn tents going up; no trade fair
VIBE	Imperial boulevards, coffee houses, Klimt	Beer gardens, river surfing, Alps on the horizon

● = edge. Fares: SBB quote for Munich supplied by you; Vienna estimated from ÖBB fare tiers because live fare lookups were blocked (see page 3).

Two rails out of the Oberland

Departures below are the actual timetable for 8 and 10 September 2026 (ÖBB Scotty data). Both routes run through Zürich HB; the Vienna Railjet is one seat for nine hours.



Munich Hbf

6 h 12 · 1 change · EC via Zürich

OUT · TUESDAY 8 SEPTEMBER

07:04 → 08:58	Interlaken West → Zürich HB	IC 809
09:32 → 13:16	Zürich HB → München Hbf	EC 99

Earlier: 05:34 via Spiez–Bern–Zürich, EC 97, arrives **11:16** (the “05:30” SBB shows). 05:01 IC 956 → same EC 97, 2 changes.

BACK · THURSDAY 10 SEPTEMBER

12:32 → 16:28	München Hbf → Zürich HB	EC 192
17:02 → 18:53	Zürich HB → Interlaken West	IC 826

Later: EC 190 14:32 → home 20:53. Earlier: EC 196 08:32 → home 14:53.

CHF 107
ONE-WAY · 2ND CLASS

Verified on SBB for the 05:30 departure on 8 Sept (your lookup). The 07:04 sits on the same fare basis; expect the same price unless the saver quota sells out. Budget the return at the same level: **≈ CHF 214 round trip**. Book both legs on sbb.ch as one basket.

Wien Hbf

10 h 58 · 2 changes · Railjet from Zürich

OUT · TUESDAY 8 SEPTEMBER

06:34 → 07:25	Interlaken West → Bern	IC 608
07:31 → 08:28	Bern → Zürich HB (4-min hop)	IC 707
08:32 → 17:32	Zürich HB → Wien Hbf	RJX 13477

Safer connection: IC 811 08:04 → Zürich 09:58, RJX 13479 10:32 → Wien **19:32** (1 change, 34-min buffer).

BACK · THURSDAY 10 SEPTEMBER

10:28 → 19:28	Wien Hbf → Zürich HB	RJX 13470
20:02 → 21:54	Zürich HB → Bern → Interlaken West	IC 832 · ICE 375

Earlier: EC 1218 07:13 via München, home 18:53. Night: NJ 21:39 → Zürich ~08:20 Fri (turns Thursday into a full day).

≈ CHF 130–185
ONE-WAY · ESTIMATE

Not a live quote. Interlaken West–Zürich ≈ CHF 70 full fare (≈ 35 with Halbtax) plus the Railjet: ÖBB Sparschiene tiers of €59.90–99.90 typically remain three days out; the flexible Standard fare is ≈ €120. To confirm: sbb.ch → **Interlaken West → Wien Hbf, 08.09.2026, 06:34**. ÖBB, DB and SBB fare services blocked automated lookups from this session.

Hot Tuesday, wet Wednesday

	VIENNA	MUNICH	INTERLAKEN (HOME)
Tuesday 8 September · travel day	32° / 18° ☀️ Mostly sunny 5% chance of rain	30° / 17° ☁️ Warm, partly cloudy 52% chance of a shower	29° / 19° ☁️ Muggy 75% · 2 mm
Wednesday 9 September · full day	24° / 17° 🌧️ Rain showers 83% · ≈ 9 mm	21° / 14° ⚡ Thunderstorms 97% · ≈ 27 mm	18° / 14° 🌧️ Rain 92% · ≈ 17 mm
Thursday 10 September · travel day	20° / 16° ☁️ Overcast 66% chance, little rain	17° / 12° ☁️ Cloudy, cool 41% chance	17° / 12° ☁️ Cloudy 43% chance

Open-Meteo model run of 5 Sept 2026; a five-day outlook is directionally reliable, not exact. Sunset: Vienna 19:22, Munich 19:41. Pack for 30° on Tuesday and a rain jacket for Wednesday either way.

The calendar

Tue VIENNA	Wiener Staatsoper · <i>Adriana Lecouvreur</i>, 19:00 Cilea, with Ermonela Jaho and Elīna Garanča. Seats €88–145 still on sale. Reachable from the 06:34 train (Hbf → Karlsplatz is 10 minutes).
Wed VIENNA	Staatsoper · <i>Le nozze di Figaro</i>, 19:00 Sold out; standing-room tickets are released on the day. Also: Kino am Dach, open-air films on the city library roof, nightly to 11 Sept.
Thu VIENNA	Staatsoper · <i>Don Carlo</i>, 19:00 €88–253. Only reachable if you take the Nightjet home instead of the 10:28 Railjet.
Wed MUNICH	The Black Keys · <i>Zenith</i>, 20:00 Indoor venue in Freimann, U6 to Freimann. A good answer to a stormy evening.
All MUNICH	Oktoberfest build-up The Wiesn opens 19 Sept (to 4 Oct). On 8–10 Sept the Theresienwiese is a construction site and hotel rates are still pre-festival. No trade fair in this window; Intergeo follows on 15–17 Sept.

OPTION A

Vienna

The grandest city in German-speaking Europe, built for an empire of fifty million and now inhabited by two. Nowhere else does a Tuesday night at the opera feel this normal.

- 1 Density of masterpieces.** Klimt at the Belvedere, Bruegel and Vermeer at the Kunsthistorisches, Schönbrunn's 1,441 rooms, all inside a 20-minute tram ride.
- 2 Coffee-house life.** A melange and a newspaper at Café Central is a legitimate two-hour plan. Sachertorte is not a cliché, it is lunch.
- 3 The Staatsoper.** A different opera every night of your stay, seats from €88, and it is 500 metres from the Sacher.

ARRIVE

Wien Hbf · U1 to Stephansplatz, 6 min

SPEND

Euro · cards everywhere · tipping 5–10%

GET AROUND

Wiener Linien 48-h pass ≈ €14

WATCH OUT

Wednesday showers · museums close 18:00

Six things worth the eleven hours



Schönbrunn

≈ €30 grand tour

Habsburg summer palace. Go at 08:30 opening, then climb to the Gloriette for the view. Gardens are free.



Belvedere

≈ €18

Klimt's *The Kiss* in the Upper Belvedere, Schiele and Kokoschka next door. The rainy-Wednesday move.



Stephansdom

Nave free • tower ≈ €7

Gothic heart of the city. 343 steps up the south tower for the tiled-roof close-up; the catacombs are the quieter tour.



Naschmarkt

Free

1.5 km of stalls, Levantine snacks and Viennese vegetable stands. Lunch at Neni or a Käsekrainer at a stand.



Riesenrad, Prater

≈ €14

The 1897 Ferris wheel from *The Third Man*. Twenty minutes in a wooden cabin at golden hour; the Prater woods for a run.



Coffee-house hour

Torte + melange ≈ €14

Café Sacher for the original torte, Café Central for the room, Café Prückel or Sperl for the locals' version.

Four beds, four budgets

Nightly rates for 8 → 10 Sept 2026, 1 adult, as listed on Google Hotels on 5 Sept
CHF at 0.94 per euro · totals are for two nights



Hotel Sacher Wien ★ 4.5 · 14.1K reviews

Philharmonikerstraße, behind the Staatsoper · 1st district

The icon: red velvet, the original torte downstairs, doormen in livery. You are paying for the address and the story, and on a two-night trip that is a defensible choice.

- Grand hotel
- Opera at the door
- Café Sacher

€646 / night Deluxe room via Priceline / Skyscanner
2 nights €1,292 ≈ CHF 1,215



Grand Ferdinand ★ 4.4 · 2.6K reviews

Schubertring, on the Ringstraße · 1st district

A 1950s Ringstraße block turned design hotel: rooftop pool with a view of the Belvedere, Meissl & Schaadl schnitzel restaurant at street level, Thonet chairs everywhere.

- Design
- Rooftop pool
- Tablet award

€213 / night Via Priceline · 2 nights €426 ≈ CHF 401



25hours Hotel at MuseumsQuartier ★ 4.5 · 4.9K reviews

Lerchenfelder Straße · 7th district, Neubau

Circus-themed, playful, with the best rooftop bar in the city (Dachboden) and the MuseumsQuartier across the road. Rooms are compact; the terrace at sunset is the reason to stay.

- Playful
- Rooftop bar
- Free cancellation

€210 / night Lowest listed rate · 2 nights €420 ≈ CHF 395



Ruby Marie ★ 4.6 · 3.6K reviews

Kaiserstraße, off Mariahilfer Straße · 6th district

“Lean luxury”: small, well-made rooms, a 24-hour bar, a rooftop with deckchairs, and the best rating of the four. Ten minutes by U3 to Stephansplatz. Hard to beat at this price.

- Value
- Rooftop
- Top-rated

€92 / night Cozy room via Priceline · 2 nights €184 ≈ CHF 173

Also priced for these nights: Hotel Imperial €495 (official site, Classic Room, 4.7★) · Hotel Kaiserhof €234 (4.8★) · Hotel Am Konzerthaus MGallery €330 · Hotel Beethoven €104 (4.7★) · Ruby Lissi €181.

One evening, one day, one morning

Built around the 06:34 out and 10:28 back
Swap to the 08:04 train if a 4-minute change in Zürich worries you (arrive 19:32, skip the opera)



Tuesday

Arrival • 32° and sunny

Opera night

- 17:32** Arrive Wien Hbf. U1 two stops to Karlsplatz, check in, shower.
- 18:30** Quick dinner at Naschmarkt (Neni, Umar) or a Würstelstand at Albertina.
- 19:00** Staatsoper: *Adriana Lecouvreur*, Jaho and Garanča. Tickets €88–145 on wiener-staatsoper.at now.
- 22:15** Nightcap and Sachertorte at Café Sacher, or the Loos Bar (tiny, 1908, perfect).



Wednesday

Full day • showers from midday

Museums

- 08:30** Schönbrunn at opening (U4 to Schönbrunn, 12 min). Grand Tour, then the Gloriette before the crowds.
- 11:30** Tram back along the Ring; lunch at Naschmarkt under cover.
- 13:30** Belvedere (The Kiss) or the Kunsthistorisches. Rain does not matter here.
- 16:30** Coffee-house hour: Café Central, then Stephansdom and the Graben on foot.
- 19:00** Figaro standing room if you can get it; otherwise Heuriger dinner at a Grinzing wine tavern (tram 38).



Thursday

Departure • overcast, 20°

Slow start

- 08:00** Breakfast at Café Prückel or the hotel; walk the Stadtpark to the Riesenrad if you skipped it.
- 09:45** U1 to Wien Hbf, buy a Manner-wafer supply.
- 10:28** RJX 13470 to Zürich, IC 832 and ICE 375 to Interlaken West, home 21:54.
- Alt.** Nightjet 21:39 → Zürich 08:20 Fri gives you all of Thursday and *Don Carlo*. Only if Friday morning is free.



OPTION B

Munich

Bavaria's easy-going capital: a Gothic square, a river you can surf, and the biggest urban park in Europe with a beer garden at its centre. Six hours from Interlaken, door to door.

- 1 Two full days instead of one.** Arrive for lunch on Tuesday, leave after lunch on Thursday. Nothing about the trip is rushed.
- 2 Outdoors first.** The Eisbach surfers, the Englischer Garten and the Viktualienmarkt are all free, and Tuesday will be 30° and dry.
- 3 World-class indoors for Wednesday.** Deutsches Museum, the Pinakotheken and the Residenz absorb a thunderstorm without effort.

ARRIVE

München Hbf · 15-min walk or S-Bahn 1 stop to Marienplatz

SPEND

Euro · cash still useful in beer gardens

GET AROUND

MVV day ticket zone M ≈ €9.20 · walkable centre

WATCH OUT

Wed storms · Wiesen grounds closed for build-up

Six things, most of them free



Marienplatz

Free · tower ≈ €6

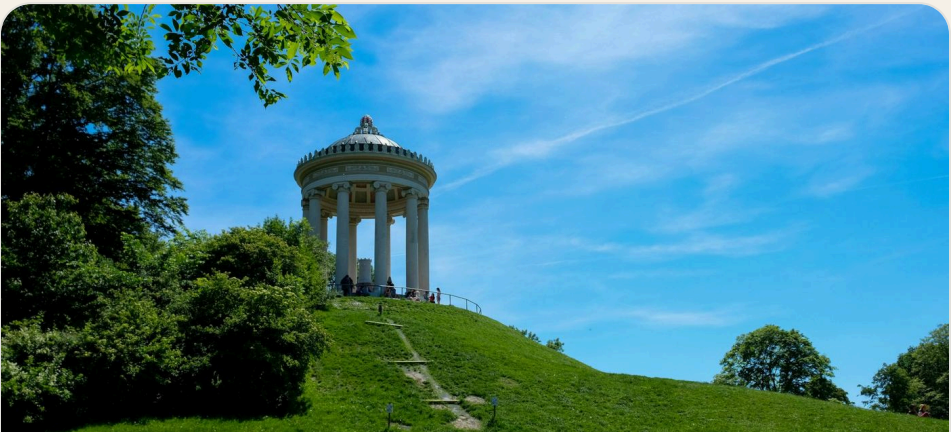
Neo-Gothic Rathaus and the Glockenspiel at 11:00, 12:00 and 17:00. Climb St Peter's (Alter Peter) for the view on page 9.



Eisbach surfers

Free

A standing wave on a city stream, surfed year-round at the edge of the Englischer Garten. Ten minutes of watching is compulsory.



Englischer Garten

Free · Maß ≈ €11

Bigger than Central Park. Monopteros for the skyline, the Chinesischer Turm beer garden for a Maß and Obatzda under the chestnuts.



Viktualienmarkt

Free

Two-hundred-year-old food market off Marienplatz: cheese stalls, Weißwurst before noon, a beer garden under the maypole.



Nymphenburg

≈ €12 palace · park free

Baroque summer palace with a canal, swans and the Gallery of Beauties. Tram 17 from the Hauptbahnhof, 15 minutes.



Frauenkirche

Free · tower ≈ €10

The twin onion domes on every skyline. The south tower reopened with a lift; on a clear day you see the Alps.

Four beds, four budgets

Nightly rates for 8 → 10 Sept 2026, 1 adult, as listed on Google Hotels on 5 Sept
CHF at 0.94 per euro · totals are for two nights



Hotel Bayerischer Hof

★ 4.4 · 4.6K reviews

Promenadeplatz · Altstadt, 5 min from Marienplatz

Munich’s grand hotel since 1841, family-run, with a rooftop pool and terrace looking at the Frauenkirche, Falk’s Bar, and a jazz club in the cellar. Cheaper than Vienna’s equivalent by a wide margin.

- Grand hotel
- Rooftop pool
- Altstadt

€400 / night

Standard double via Priceline
2 nights €800 ≈ CHF 752



Louis Hotel

★ 4.4 · 609 reviews

Viktualienmarkt · Altstadt

Seventy-two calm, timber-and-stone rooms above the market, a courtyard terrace, and a Japanese restaurant (Emiko) on the roof. The design pick, and you fall out of bed into the Viktualienmarkt.

- Design
- Market views
- Rooftop dining

€294 / night

Courtyard Superior via Priceline
2 nights €588 ≈ CHF 553



Platzl Hotel

★ 4.5 · 1.5K reviews

Sparkassenstraße, opposite the Hofbräuhaus · Altstadt

Family-owned Bavarian classic: wood panelling, a Moorish-style spa, the Pfistermühle restaurant in a 16th-century mill. Old-Munich charm at a mid-range price, on the quietest lane in the centre.

- Bavarian classic
- Spa
- Family-run

€210 / night

Classic Queen via Priceline
2 nights €420 ≈ CHF 395



Ruby Lilly

★ 4.4 · 2.7K reviews

Dachauer Straße, Stiglmaierplatz · Maxvorstadt

Same lean-luxury formula as Vienna’s Ruby Marie: compact rooms, a good bar, a terrace, and the Pinakotheken ten minutes away on foot. Two U-Bahn stops from the Hauptbahnhof.

- Value
- Near the museums
- Bar

from €144 / night

Google Hotels list rate;
Wow Room €229 via
Priceline
2 nights from €288 ≈ CHF
271

Also priced for these nights: Schwan Locke aparthotel €89 (Locke Studio, 4.3★) · Pullman Munich €125 · Munich Marriott €159 · Mercure City Center €169 · NH Collection Bavaria €199 · 25hours The Royal Bavarian from €644 (almost sold out).

Two full days, one lazy morning

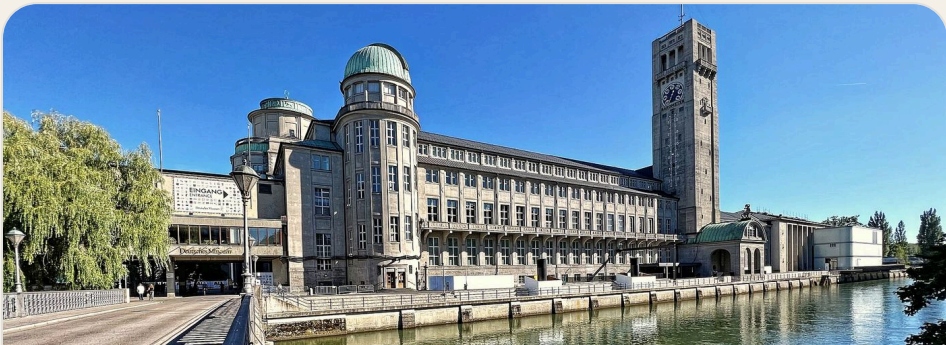


Tuesday

Arrival · 30° and warm

Outdoors

- 11:16** Arrive München Hbf. Drop bags, walk 15 min to Marienplatz.
- 12:00** **Glockenspiel**, then lunch under the maypole at the **Viktualienmarkt** beer garden.
- 14:00** Frauenkirche and **Alter Peter** tower; Residenz courtyards on the way north.
- 16:00** **Eisbach surfers**, then the Englischer Garten to the Monopteros.
- 18:30** **Chinesischer Turm** beer garden till sunset at 19:41; U-Bahn back from Giselastraße.



Wednesday

Full day · thunderstorms

Indoors

- 09:00** **Deutsches Museum** at opening (mines, aviation, the physics shows). Three hours vanish.
- 12:30** Lunch at **Schneider Bräuhaus** (Weißwurst, Tap 4) under a roof.
- 14:00** **Alte Pinakothek** (Dürer, Rubens) and, if the storm holds, the Pinakothek der Moderne next door.
- 17:00** **Residenz** Treasury and the Cuvilliés Theatre, last entry 17:00 in summer hours.
- 20:00** **The Black Keys** at the Zenith (U6 Freimann), or Augustiner-Keller if the sky clears.



Thursday

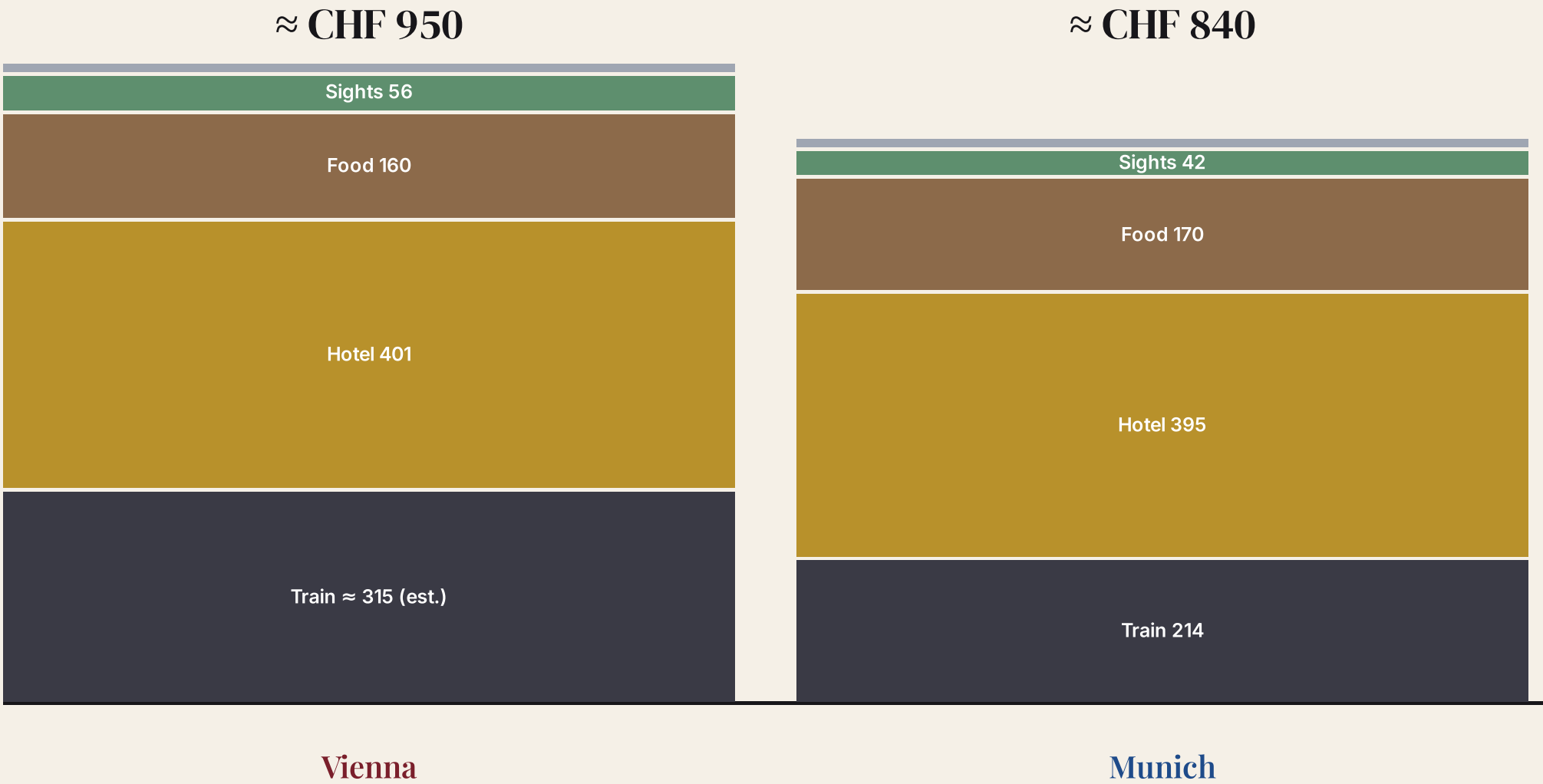
Departure · cool, 17°

Palace

- 09:00** Tram 17 to **Nymphenburg** at opening: palace, then the canal and the Amalienburg in the park.
- 11:15** Tram back to the Hauptbahnhof; Leberkäsemmel from the station bakery for the train.
- 12:32** **EC 192** to Zürich (16:28), IC 826 to Interlaken West, home 18:53.
- Alt.** Stay for lunch at Nymphenburg's Schlosscafé and take EC 190 at 14:32, home 20:53.

What three days actually costs

Per person, in CHF, mid-range hotel (Grand Ferdinand / Platzl) · food €85 a day · sights as listed · local transport
Value variant: Ruby Marie €92 / Ruby Lilly €144



LINE	VIENNA	MUNICH
Train, return	≈ 315 est.	214
Hotel, 2 nights (mid)	401	395
Food and drink	160	170
Sights	56	42
Local transport	16	19
Mid-range trip	≈ 950	≈ 840
Value variant (Ruby hotels)	≈ 720	≈ 715

Train Hotel Food Sights Local transport

At the value end the two trips cost the same; Vienna's extra train fare is offset by cheaper beds. The real gap is ten hours of your time.

Five clicks, in order

- ☐ Decide by tonight: hotel rates were live on 5 Sept and the Ruby, Platzl and 25hours rooms are the ones that vanish first.
- ☐ Train on **sbb.ch** Interlaken West → München Hbf, 08.09.2026, and the return 10.09.2026 (EC 192, 12:32). Confirm CHF 107 each way; a saver fare is train-specific, so pick the departure you will actually make.
- ☐ If you go for Vienna instead: same search to Wien Hbf, 06:34 out and 10:28 back, then buy *Adriana* wiener-staatsoper.at the same minute. *Lecouvreur*
- ☐ Book the hotel on the official site once you have the Google price as a reference; Sacher, Imperial, Bayerischer Hof and Ruby usually match or beat the OTA rate with breakfast thrown in.
- ☐ Pack for 30° on Tuesday and a storm on Wednesday. Museums, opera and beer halls do not care about the weather; the Englischer Garten does, so it goes on Tuesday.

Assumptions: one adult, 2nd class, no rail pass. With a Halbtax the Swiss legs halve ($\approx$ CHF 35 saved each way to Zürich). Times are the published timetable and can change on the day; check the app the evening before.

Where the numbers come from

- Train times** · ÖBB Scotty HAFAS timetable for 8 and 10 Sept 2026, queried 5 Sept.
- Munich fare** · SBB, Interlaken West → München, 05:30 on 8 Sept: CHF 107, checked by the traveller.
- Vienna fare** · Estimate from SBB domestic tariff (Interlaken–Zürich) plus ÖBB Sparschiene / Standard tiers. Live fare APIs at bahn.de, ÖBB and Booking refused automated access on 5 Sept; nothing here is a “from” marketing price.
- Hotel rates** · Google Hotels listings for 8–10 Sept 2026, 1 adult, EUR, retrieved 5 Sept 2026; provider named on each card.
- Weather** · Open-Meteo forecast run of 5 Sept 2026.
- Events** · wiener-staatsoper.at (Sept 2026 calendar), munich.travel event listings, oktoberfest.de.
- FX** · Frankfurter / ECB reference rate, 4 Sept 2026: 1 EUR = 0.9405 CHF.
- Photos** · Unsplash: Martin Zenker (Schönbrunn), Daniel Seßler and Anastasiya Dalenka (Marienplatz), Sergey Mind (Rathaus), David Vives (Schönbrunn courtyard), Amir Arsalan Shamsabadi (Stephansdom), Fiona Frommelt and Jorge Franganillo (Naschmarkt), Luke Wang (Sachertorte), Joshi Milestoner (Staatsoper), Carrie Borden (Vienna dusk), Rikin Katyal (Café Central), Alistair MacRobert (Eisbach), Robert Biedermann (Monopteros), Sarah Donovan and Annie Spratt (Viktualienmarkt), Henry Lloyd and Dovlet Hojayev (Nymphenburg), Joshua Kettle and Daniel Schmidt (Frauenkirche), Laszlo Biro (Railjet). Wikimedia Commons, CC BY-SA: Belvedere (Diego Delso), Riesenrad, Deutsches Museum. Hotel photographs from the hotels’ own listings on Google Hotels.